

Probation and Onboarding Guide

Document ID: HR-POL-005 Version: 2.0

Effective Date: 1 June 2025 Owner: People Operations

Classification: Internal Supersedes: HR-POL-005 v1.4

1. The probation period

All new employees serve a probation period of 90 calendar days from their start date. The purpose of probation is to confirm that the role and the employee are a good fit for each other. Probation may be extended once, by a maximum of 60 calendar days, where the line manager and People Operations agree more time is needed. An extension must be communicated to the employee in writing before the original probation period ends.

2. Reviews during probation

Day 30 check-in is informal: the line manager and employee discuss early progress, no written record required. Day 60 review is written: the line manager records progress against induction objectives and flags concerns. Day 85 confirmation review is written: the line manager recommends confirmation, extension, or termination, and People Operations must receive the recommendation no later than day 85 so the employee can be notified before probation ends.

3. Notice periods

Notice requirements differ during and after probation. The applicable period is determined by the employee's status on the date notice is given.

Employment status | Notice from employee | Notice from company

During probation, including any extension | 7 calendar days, in writing | 7 calendar days, in writing

Confirmed employee, below manager grade | 30 calendar days, in writing | 30 calendar days, in writing

Confirmed employee, manager grade and above | 60 calendar days, in writing | 60 calendar days, in writing

The company may elect to pay salary in lieu of notice. Notice given during probation does not require a reason to be stated, although one is normally given as a matter of good practice.

4. Leave during probation

Employees may take annual leave during probation, subject to the usual approval process in HR-POL-002. Annual leave continues to accrue throughout the probation period. Taking leave during probation does not extend the probation period.

5. Induction checklist

Day 1: equipment issued, accounts created, security briefing completed, see IT-POL-001. Day 1: signed acknowledgement of the Employee Handbook filed with People Operations. Week 1: objectives for the probation period agreed in writing with the line manager. Week 2: introduction to the relevant finance and procurement processes, FIN-POL-003 and PROC-PRO-002.

6. Confirmation

On successful completion of probation, People Operations issues a confirmation letter. Confirmation takes effect from the day after probation ends. Benefits conditional on confirmation, including the private medical scheme and the training allowance, become available on that date.